

Staff Days — Week 1, Day 4 (Thu Jul 30)

Format note: Joe wasn't the main speaker today. The morning was Mackenzie Price and Anna Devlantes on marketing and media, then Cameron on Founder School. Joe contributed two blocks, marked below.

Morning, Part 1 — Mackenzie Price & Anna Devlantes: *How We Educate Parents*

0:01–1:27

The strategy

Mackenzie opened with the origin story — frustration with her daughters' public school in 2014, co-founding with Brian Holtz out of the ground floor of his house, and Joe's daughters trying it for a week and refusing to go to summer camp. The takeaway she draws: **nobody can imagine what Alpha is until they see it**, because everyone's mental model of school is the one they grew up in. So the marketing job is three steps: **show them** → **let them experience it** → **connect them to the community**.

Alpha Summer is step two. Step three is why parent testimonials and the parent community matter — moving schools means giving up a community, and parents need to believe they're gaining a better one. The example she gave was a mom who loved her school because of her tennis group, while her son was bored, bullied, and faking illness.

Three channels

1. Video content (Chris Moss, Haven Moss, Gabby Guajardo). Scaling from a few campuses to ~50 means changes:

- **No rogue filming.** Don't hire your own videographer or photographer. Everything goes through the central team so the national brand stays consistent. Each campus gets a consistent crew who knows the kids and families.
- Tell them what's coming — banger workshops, and when. They can't film the plane flight if they don't know it's happening.
- If they don't pick your workshop, it's not personal; they may already have that content or be balancing coverage across campuses.
- **Swag and decor** run through the centralized team. Campus identity is welcome (a surfboard in Santa Barbara), but within brand guidelines. A Canva brand kit was requested and agreed to.

2. Social media — over 500 million organic views and 1.75M followers in three years, all under the *Future of Education* brand. Her point: education content online is uniformly bleak, so the

optimistic message stands out. This is where the Today Show, NYT, WSJ, Dr. Phil, and Newsweek all came from.

Hard rules:

- **Kids are always the first priority.** Anyone can say no to a shoot at any time.
- Media consent is entirely the parent's choice. Non-consenting kids wear **wristbands** so they stay in the activity instead of being pulled out.
- Nothing is ever edited to make a kid or a guide look bad.
- **Do not post children on your personal social media accounts.** Be thoughtful about your personal accounts generally — parents look.
- **Teachers 2.0** squad exists for guides who want to shoot their own content; you don't have to be a member. Send raw footage to the team and they'll edit it.

3. Press and PR (Anna). ~33,884 stories about Alpha in 2026 so far, at 91% positive sentiment. Alpha now turns down more media than it accepts.

- **Alpha is not political, not religious, and holds no social points of view.** The answer to any version of the question is the three commitments. Families come from across the spectrum. Separately, Alpha is openly pro-school-choice, because vouchers are what make Texas Sports Academy free for 1,000+ kids — expect to see Alpha on Fox, CNN, and NPR, and expect NPR coverage to skew negative.
- **Mackenzie's public plea: bring back "both sides."** Kids arguing both sides of a question (her example: why I should and shouldn't have a later bedtime). She suggested it as a check chart item.
- **The hit-piece formula**, so you can recognize it: an email with ~12 loaded questions and a 48-hour deadline. They will use only the fragment that fits the narrative they already have. Wired and NPR are the current examples; 100% of Brownsville parents signed a letter disputing the Wired piece. **Alpha will never pull a student's records into public to rebut a story**, even when the records contradict the claim.
- **If media contacts you, route it.** Reporters are showing up in parking lots and at info sessions. The script: "I want to help you — let me connect you with the right person." Same for podcast requests, so they don't collide with a bigger booking. You're not required to be a PR agent; media training will be offered on Zoom.
- **Messaging technique: lean in, agree, pivot, differentiate.** The worked example was screen time — acknowledge the concern sincerely, then draw the distinction between doomscrolling and one-to-one mastery-based tutoring, and land on the fact that Alpha kids get *less* screen time and more human interaction than most students.
- Coming this year: episodic content (a year in the life, follow a workshop), more documentary work, and a *60 Minutes* conversation via Barry Weiss.

Joe's addendum (1:33:51)

The reason the media strategy works: **Alpha markets to parents, and everyone else in education markets to gatekeepers** — districts, administrators, the establishment. The filter on any message is "would this help a parent decide?" Critics online arguing that sports in the afternoon is educational malpractice are not the audience; the Sports Academy team reports that those arguments multiply their reach among the parents who *are*.

Morning, Part 2 — Cameron: *Founder School & the \$100M Offer Framework*

1:35–2:42

Founder School launches in New York in September. The offer: **earn \$1M in profit before high school graduation, or full tuition refunded** — no caveats. Tuition is \$150,000/year. The guarantee is per-year in practice: each year is a one-year commitment with clear benchmarks for reinvasion, and if Alpha loses confidence in a student, the money is refunded no questions asked. Internally they're framing it as Navy SEALs with an expected ~50% attrition early on, targeting 70–80% success by year four or five.

Alex Hormozi's framework, as applied

The thesis in one sentence: **make an offer so good people feel stupid saying no**. The elements — an unmatched promotion, an unmatched value proposition, a premium price, an unbeatable guarantee, and a money model that funds growth. The value equation is dream outcome × perceived likelihood, divided by time and effort.

Key design lesson: **caveats ruin the offer**. They debated revenue vs. profit vs. valuation and landed on a million dollars of profit because it fits in one sentence and needs no explanation. Alex Hormozi gifted 250 copies of *\$100M Offers* to the room; Cameron's ask is that everyone use the framework on their own workshops.

Other Founder School notes: the freshman-year curriculum page is what actually sells families; a philosophy book list sits alongside the business curriculum (philosopher builders again); every freshman must land and execute a **\$10,000 AI consulting engagement**; assessments are "founder's tests," not alpha tests. Year-one priorities beyond the flagship: micro-school pods (San Francisco in conversation), weekend/after-school/summer programming, a **Founders track inside Alpha schools at L2 and L3**, and a game team building business simulation games with mentor partners.

Founders Weekends have massively overshot — designed for 30 kids each, they're running 60–130 per city with 500+ signups across six events.

Joe's application to the life skill stacks (2:35–2:41)

This is the part that generalizes to everyone's work. Each of the five life skill domains needs its **own million-dollar-equivalent end offer** at the top of the K–12 stack. Entrepreneurship already has one: kindergartners learn earn/save/spend/invest/donate, and it scaffolds to "you can earn a million dollars in high school." Storytelling and public speaking, relationship building, and the others need the same.

Three properties of a good stack offer:

1. **It's kid-centric, not just parent-centric** — the test is whether a student would rather do this than take summer break.
2. **A compelling enough outcome recruits anyone you need.** Want storytelling? Pixar will help. Public speaking? TEDx. Mackenzie was in front of Disney's CEO and the first question was "what's the outcome?"
3. **It has to scaffold logically K–12**, so an 8-year-old can see the path and want in early. The evidence this works: parents at Founders Weekends are already transferring 10-year-olds into Alpha so they'll be eligible for Founder School at 14.

Post-Lunch Tee-Up — *The Boot Camp to Banger Arc*

2:42–2:53

The week's build sessions, laid out as a structure:

Day	What was built
Mon	Alpha Canon — the floor. Tier 1 mandatory, Tier 2 level variance, Tier 3 guide magic
Tue	Bangers — the ceiling. The impossible thing at the end of the year
Wed	Boot camp core life skills — the foundation kids need before they can attempt a banger
Thu	Everything in between

Today's task is the **concept narrative**: the escalation that carries a kid from following a few steps of direction in Session 1 to climbing Kilimanjaro or taking over an Apple Store by Session 5. Explicitly *not* a technical build — the actual workshops get built at October and December staff days, and guides' guides get built next week. The output is a 10,000-foot roadmap of what

a student at each level experiences across Sessions 1–5 in all three dimensions (Me / We / Key), producing a 3D kid.

Bangers and boosters. Not every workshop is a banger — "if everyone is a banger, then none of them are." The banger is the end of the arc; boosters are the life skill supplements that get kids there.

The model example was the Day 2 beekeeper pitch, which jumped dimensions across sessions while keeping the medium constant: independence → socialization → grit → entrepreneurship. Food Truck did the same thing. Arcs are encouraged to cross sessions and dimensions.

Structure: level groups first (horizontal — what does every L1 do), then regroup by campus (vertical — what does a Scottsdale student do), then regional heads pick one or two to pitch at 4:30. Level groups are for brainstorming, not standardization — take another campus's workshop wholesale if you like it.

Pitches included: TSA L2 running a year-long water arc (independent strokes → junior lifeguard, team-pass-or-fail → PADI certification → reef restoration in Hawaii); Miami Middle School's We progression (tattoo flash verified by a master artist → ASL → drumline → capturing Burmese pythons in the Everglades → an Olympic-style finale); Spyglass Wonder Lab's pre-K year (running their own school day, ninja gym, an AI-composed EP with original cover art, dirt bikes for grit, an Arabian Horse Association halter class, line dancing, a playdate with a frenemy, Cirque du Pre-K, a book review podcast judged by a local bookstore, Alpha-opoly, and mahjong for strategic patience).

Optional evening session — AI film production

A walkthrough of the high school AI video workshop: connecting **Higgsfield** to Claude as a custom MCP connector, then building character/location/prop **reference sheets** saved as reusable "elements" to solve the continuity problem, generating voices, and using shot lists for multi-shot sequences. Roughly 90 minutes of iteration produced 15 seconds of Pixar-quality animation — Pixar's own cost for that is \$417K–\$556K. Text should be added afterward in CapCut rather than generated. Ideas floated: an Alpha AI film festival, weekend hackathons, pitching film execs. Students were reportedly working on these until 12:30am voluntarily.